

Fire Merit Commission September 11th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0N60uEBUAz8
Publication Date	2025-09-11T22:21:56Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called to order the September monthly meeting of the Muncie Fire Merit Commission [00:00:19](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Kevin, Lennon, Andrew Bale, Linda Gray, Mike Widen
 - **Staff/Others Present:** Chief Berford, Mark Irvin (Attorney), Miss White, Samra
 - **Members Absent:** Not explicitly stated.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title, but led the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The commission observed a memorial segment reading the names of Indiana residents who perished in the September 11 terrorist attacks, followed by a moment of silence for fallen firefighters, police officers, and public safety personnel [00:02:43](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the September 14, 2025 meeting were approved by voice vote [00:01:11](#).
 - **Agenda Modification:** Approved a motion to add an eighth item under the 2026 promotion process regarding the annual budget [00:00:43](#).
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:08:32](#) **2026 Promotions Process & Hiring Process**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer and Chief Berford.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission discussed timelines for the upcoming 2026 promotional process (sign-ups in mid-October, cutoff around October 20th, with testing running from February through early March). Chief Berford noted potential updates to reference materials and the integration of new Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) if finalized by early December. Additionally, the commission discussed opening the firefighter hiring application process early, running from October 1st through December 31st, to prepare lists and accommodate physical testing (CPAT and ladder climbs) in early 2025/2026. Recruitment strategies include local community outreach via QR codes at the homecoming parade and utilizing community promotion funds to attract local applicants less likely to laterally transfer away.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:14:39](#).
 - [00:14:51](#) **Annual Budget Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The annual budget of approximately \$34,000 has been submitted and introduced at city council. It remains consistent with the previous year's budget and covers operating needs, including meeting video recording costs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote required.
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No open public comment period or general citizen forum was held during this meeting.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Chief Berford reported that department recruits are two-thirds through EMT class and will soon move to floor/shift positions.

- Certifications from August and September were included in member packets.
 - Rules and amendments were signed, dated, and distributed.
 - The annual Denise Moore Leadership Award will be presented to a department individual at next month's meeting.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote 00:15:45.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-26 02:03:51 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.